TUESDAY
NOVEMBER 3, 2026
JUMADA AL ULA 23, 1448

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WAM

UAE ONE BALLOON TAKES TO THE SKIES OF JAPAN

- The UAE ONE balloon takes to the skies over Saga, Japan, marking the first Arab participation in the 39th Saga International Balloon Fiesta, which runs until today. The UAE's hot-air balloon is participating in this prestigious festival alongside hundreds of international teams from the United Kingdom, Poland, Thailand, South Korea, Malaysia, the United States, Australia, Brazil, China and Singapore.

Mohammed calls for bold AI solutions in UAE

ANNUAL GOVERNMENT CHALLENGE LOOKS TO THE FUTURE

DUBAI

BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, has launched the Annual Government Challenge, a new national platform that enables employees of federal ministries and entities to take part in designing and developing innovative solutions for national priorities, and to turn outstanding ideas into practical, scalable projects and models that enhance the efficiency of government work and its readiness for the future.

Energy, expertise, talent

Launched in conjunction with UAE Innovation Month, the challenge harnesses the energy, expertise and talent of government employees and strengthens collaboration among teams across federal entities, with each annual edition dedicated to a national priority. The first edition will focus on developing Agentic AI solutions and applying them to redesign services and operations, enhance decision making and raise government performance. It will be overseen by the Mohammed Bin Rashid Centre for Government Innovation at the Ministry of Cabinet Affairs.

The first edition will conclude with the honouring of nine winning projects across the challenge's three categories, with total prizes of Dh9 million.

Sheikh Mohammed said, "As UAE Innovates begins, we launch today the Annual Government Challenge for UAE Government employees and teams. A new national initiative to inspire our government talent to create bold new solutions with real impact on our services, operations and projects. The first challenge: Agentic AI. We will honour the top 9 government projects and teams. We want unconventional ideas. Solutions that make a difference. Projects that take government work to new levels."

Dedicating the first edition to Agentic AI reflects a priority to accelerate the shift of federal entities from using AI tools to redesigning services, operations and operating models around its capabilities, strengthening the integration of the government system and its readiness for the next phase.

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Three categories

The challenge comprises three main categories.

- **Government Services** focuses on solutions that directly serve customers by redesigning the service journey, simplifying procedures, cutting time and steps, and delivering faster, simpler and more proactive services.
- **Internal Operations** focuses on improving ways of working within government entities, covering internal procedures and operations, coordination, monitoring, analysis and decision making. It aims to reduce repetitive work, accelerate delivery, raise employee productivity, and improve resource efficiency and the quality of performance.
- **Unconventional Ideas** opens the door to bold new solutions that reimagine the role of government and how it works, offering unconventional models that create new opportunities for government work, accelerate national targets, and strengthen the UAE's competitiveness and leadership.

Adnoc, OpenAI seal major deal

Move to cut oilfield planning from months to hours

ABU DHABI

BY RAHF YOUSSEF
Reporter

Energy security, disruptions to global oil supplies and major artificial intelligence partnerships dominated the opening day of ADIPEC 2026 yesterday.

Adnoc announced a multi-year agreement with OpenAI and G42 to integrate AI across its operations, saying the partnership could cut complex oilfield development planning from months to hours. Adnoc will also become the first energy company to deploy OpenAI Frontier.

Dr Sultan Ahmed Al Jaber, UAE Minister of Industry and Advanced Technology and Adnoc Managing Director and Group CEO, warned that nearly one billion barrels had been drawn from global oil inventories following disruptions to the Strait of Hormuz. Shipping costs, he said, had risen from less than 5 per cent to more than 30 per cent of a barrel's cost.

OpenAI CEO Sam Altman identified energy availability as a major constraint on AI growth. Abu Dhabi also announced AI agreements covering government regulatory compliance, investment analysis and wider technology adoption. ADIPEC opened with representatives from more than 170 countries, 2,260 exhibiting companies and 40 government ministers.

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El Sayed's primary rival endorses GOP opponent in Michigan | P8-9



ABU DHABI

Head to Khalifa Park for a slice of calm and charm | PIII



